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Multiplatformní desktopová aplikace pro vizualizaci a analýzu telemetrických dat z testovacích jízd automobilů

ABSTRAKT

Sem vyplňte abstrakt své práce v češtině.

Klíčová slova: DOPLŇTE, SEM, KLÍČOVÁ, SLOVA

Multiplatform desktop application for visualization and analysis of telemetry data from car test drives

ABSTRACT

Insert the abstract of your theses in English here.

Keywords: INSERT, KEYWORDS, HERE

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to acknowledge everyone who contributed to the creation of this fine piece of work.

Bc. Petr Boháč

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

OBD-II	On-Board Diagnostics II
ECU	Electronic Control Unit
ODIS	Offboard Diagnostic Information System
PWM	Pulse-Width Modulation
INCA	Integrated Calibration and Acquisition System
MDF	Measurement Data Format

1 INTRODUCTION

In 2025, the Czech automotive giant Škoda Auto produced over 1,043,900 vehicles [1]. At the time of writing, the company is actively manufacturing and selling around 11 different models, including the popular Škoda Octavia, Škoda Fabia, and Škoda Superb. It is pretty reasonable to say that there is a lot of work being done on the research and development side to keep up with demand for new cars and to keep improving existing models.

The process of designing and manufacturing a car is highly iterative. Theory alone can get you relatively far, but at the end of the day, even in a strictly controlled environment, many factors can affect the car's performance, and the only way to really understand how it performs is to test it in real life. Testing is conducted by taking the car on a standardized test drive on a public road, a test track, or in a wind tunnel.[1]. Depending on the test, specific parameters of the drive are standardized, such as speed, drive duration, and, in the case of a wind tunnel, air pressure, temperature, humidity, and the track's incline.

During the drive, a wide array of sensors collects data on various aspects of the car's performance, generating a large amount of telemetry. Tests may be conducted multiple times a day. After a while, the amount of collected data becomes quite large, making it difficult to analyze it all manually. This is where the need for a software solution arises.

The first step in the process will be to analyze the engineers' and technicians' current workflow for data analysis and identify pain points in their process. This will involve conducting interviews and observations to understand how they currently analyze the data, which tools they use, and the challenges they face. Based on this analysis, we will search for existing software solutions that could address these pain points and evaluate their suitability for our specific use case. If we find a suitable solution, we will then customize it to fit our needs.

If no suitable solution is found, requirements for a new software solution will be drawn up, including all the specific features and functionalities users might need for an efficient workflow. An important part of this process will also be to define the software's technical stack and architecture, ensuring it is scalable and maintainable for future developers.

[1]Processes described are specific to the Thermosystem department of Škoda Auto, but the general principles are likely to be similar across the whole company

2 PROBLEM ANALYSIS

As previously mentioned, the development process of a car generates a large amount of telemetry data that needs to be analyzed by engineers and technicians. The current workflow for analyzing this data is inefficient and time-consuming, which motivates the need for a software solution that can streamline the process.

2.1 MOTIVATION

Let's consider the following hypothetical scenario: blah blah tohle nefunguje tak udelame test, ten nam nameri tyhle senzory a znich pozname co zpusobuje ten problem, mrd there u go proto delame testy

2.2 DATA COLLECTION

Because different conditions reveal different aspects of a car's performance, a single standardized test is not sufficient. Instead, cars must be tested across a spectrum of environments. These environments include, but are not limited to, public roads, test tracks, and wind tunnels. By adapting each test to a specific area of investigation, engineers can gain deeper insights into how a car behaves under particular conditions, which is crucial for optimizing its design and performance. A small selection of tests used in production is illustrated in Figure 2. 1, taken from the internal configuration system, also developed by the author.

Název	Identifikátor	Prostředí	$T_{W_HWK_ein}$ (°C)	$T_{L_AUSSEN_s}$ (°C)	$T_{L_AUSSEN_e}$ (°C)	ETD_s (°C)	ETD_e (°C)	$T_{o\text{-}mot}$ (°C)	ATD (°C)	Rychlost (km/h)	Náklon (%)
6% stoupání 45°C	*6% stoupání 45°C*	Tunel	108,00	45,00	45,00	63,00	63,00	150,00	-	-	6,00
8% stoupání 45°C	*8% stoupání 45°C*	Tunel	108,00	45,00	45,00	63,00	63,00	150,00	-	-	8,00
FT mit Anhänger	*FTmit*	Tunel	108,00	24,00	24,00	84,00	84,00	150,00	-	70,00	9,00
FT mit Anhänger REAL	*Ftmit*	Silnice	117,00	30,00	24,00	87,00	93,00	150,00	-	70,00	-
GG mit Anhänger	*GGm*	Tunel	108,00	30,00	18,00	78,00	90,00	150,00	50,00	30,00	12,00
GG mit Anhänger REAL	*GGm*	Silnice	117,00	30,00	18,00	87,00	99,00	150,00	50,00	30,00	-
GG ohne Anhänger	*GGoA*	Tunel	108,00	30,00	18,00	78,00	90,00	150,00	40,00	55,00	12,00

Figure 2. 1: A snippet of the predefined tests with various parameters.

In general, vehicle telemetry data can be collected in two primary ways: through the integrated On-Board Diagnostics II (OBD-II) port [2], or by equipping the vehicle with a large number of additional sensors while simultaneously aggregating data from the car's internal systems.

2.2.1 OBD-II-BASED DATA ACQUISITION

The former method is significantly more straightforward and is commonly used for basic diagnostics and performance monitoring. The setup typically involves connecting a data-logging device, most often a laptop computer, to the vehicle's OBD-II port using a standard interface cable [2]. The computer then runs software capable of communicating with the vehicle's onboard systems, allowing it to read and record various parameters from the car's Electronic Control Unit (ECU) [3].

Any software capable of reading data from the aforementioned port can be used for this purpose, and many options are available, both open-source and commercial. At Škoda Auto, part of the Volkswagen Group, the software commonly used for this task is Offboard Diagnostic Information System (ODIS), a Volkswagen Group diagnostic system (see Figure 2. 2). It is licensed to authorized users and provides a comprehensive set of diagnostic functions for vehicle development and service use [4].

Figure 2. 2: ODIS Factory Diagnostic OEM Pro Package used in Škoda Auto.
Source: https://diagnoex.com/products/vw-audi-odis-scan-tool

The output is typically exported in CSV format, which can be easily imported into spreadsheet software or other data analysis tools for further processing. This method is trivial to set up and can provide a wide range of information about the vehicle's operation, including engine speed, coolant temperature, throttle position, and other parameters. However, due to limitations in available signals and sampling rates, it may not capture all the data required for more detailed or high-fidelity analysis.

2.2.2 INSTRUMENTED VEHICLE DATA ACQUISITION

The second method of data collection involves equipping the vehicle with a large number of additional sensors and aggregating data from the vehicle's internal systems using dedicated supporting hardware (similar to Figure 2. 3). Compared to the first approach, this method is significantly more complex and costly, and the installation process typically requires approximately two days. However, it enables the collection of far more comprehensive and detailed telemetry data, which is essential for in-depth analysis and optimization of vehicle performance.

Figure 2. 3: ETAS Hardware for Data Acquisition
Source: https://www.etas.com/ww/en/products-services/data-acquisition-processing-tools

For example, the ECU often regulates certain components through feedback control loops rather than providing direct measurements. A typical case is the main radiator fan, whose operation is controlled using Pulse-Width Modulation (PWM) to adjust the cooling power dynamically. As a result, the fan speed does not directly correspond to the engine speed, and the actual fan rotational speed

is not always available as a measured signal. In such cases, the fan speed may need to be estimated indirectly from related variables such as voltage, current, and PWM duty cycle. By installing an additional sensor that directly measures the fan's rotational speed, the system can provide a precise and readily usable measurement, which significantly simplifies subsequent analysis[2].

In this configuration, the logging device is typically a laptop computer running specialized third-party software designed for high-fidelity data acquisition. At Škoda Auto, the software commonly used for this purpose is Integrated Calibration and Acquisition System (INCA), a commercial tool developed by ETAS GmbH. This software provides advanced capabilities for data acquisition, calibration, and analysis, making it well suited for the complex requirements of high-resolution telemetry data collection [5].

Compared to the OBD-II-based method, this approach generates significantly larger datasets, often containing measurements from thousands of sensors at different high sampling rates. A simple text-based format would be impractical for storing such large volumes of data, so a more sophisticated standardized format is used. The most common format for this type of data is the Measurement Data Format (MDF), which is a binary file format designed specifically for storing large volumes of measurement data efficiently. The MDF format allows for the storage of complex datasets with multiple channels, varying sampling rates, and metadata, making it ideal for high-fidelity telemetry data [6]. The majority of technicians and engineers at Škoda Auto working with version 3 of the MDF format, but slow adoption of version 4 is expected in the near future.

Because this method has had so much time to mature, the software and hardware ecosystem around it is well developed, and the process of collecting and analyzing data is relatively streamlined. This leaves the first method slightly neglected, thus motivating the development of a software solution that focuses on improving the workflow for OBD-II-based data acquisition and analysis.

2.3 CURRENT WORKFLOW

It is no secret that large corporations across all industries prefer to use commercial software solutions for their operations, and the automotive industry is no exception. Microsoft is the dominant provider of office software, and many companies rely on it for almost all of their day to day operations from email, meetings, and document editing to data analysis and visualization.

Microsoft Excel is an excellent tool for many tasks and can be more than sufficient for for even complex data analysis. That it why it is so widely used in

[2] A photograph of the instrumented engine bay cannot be published due to confidentiality restrictions. During measurements, vehicles are equipped with numerous additional sensors and data acquisition cables, producing a dense instrumentation layout that differs substantially from the standard vehicle configuration.

the industry, including at Škoda Auto, where it is the primary tool for analyzing telemetry data collected through the OBD-II port. The current workflow is as follows:

2.3.1 DATA ACQUISITION

Data is collected using ODIS and exported in CSV format. The CSV data is then imported into Excel using its built-in import functionality, which allows users to specify data types and delimiters. Once imported, the Excel spreadsheet with a structure similar to that shown in Figure 2. 4 is saved to a shared network drive, making it accessible to other team members for further analysis and collaboration.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1	#2026-03-03 12:56:41 TMBNH9NY0SF000226 trasa MB-MIM-MB, polojasno, 6st., test sady kanalu								
2	#Time	08/vnější te	01/Rychlos	01/buzení \	01/roleta ch	08/vysokon	08/vysokon	08/vysokon	08/vysokon
3	#Time	08----	01----	01----	01----	08-Timeout	08-stav top	08-Napájec	08-stav top
4	#ms	°C	km/h	%	%	-	-	-	-
5	4980	12	2	25.39	29	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.
6	9856	11.5	5	25.39	29	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.
7	15123	11	13	0	29	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.
8	19879	10.5	14	25.39	29	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.
9	24139	10	8	25.39	29	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.
10	29220	9.5	12	25.39	29	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.
11	34075	9	6	25.39	29	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.
12	39060	8.5	7	25.39	29	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.	v poř.

Figure 2. 4: Structure of the Excel spreadsheet after importing the CSV data.

2.3.2 DATA ANALYSIS

Engineers and technicians use Excel's functions, formulas, and pivot tables to analyze the data. This analysis may include calculating summary statistics, creating charts and graphs, and performing basic data manipulation on a single file. When multiple test runs need to be compared, engineers must manually open several spreadsheets and compare the data side by side. This process can become cumbersome and error-prone as the number of files increases, especially on the corporate-issued laptops, which often have limited processing power, memory and a small screen size.

It is this second part of the workflow that is particularly inefficient and time-consuming, which motivates the effort to find a better solution.

2.4 EXISTING SOLUTIONS

Before developing a custom tool, it is necessary to examine existing solutions for vehicle telemetry acquisition and analysis. These solutions range from professional automotive engineering tools used by manufacturers to more general-

purpose diagnostic or telemetry platforms. While many of these tools provide powerful capabilities, they often target different use cases or impose limitations that make them unsuitable for the workflow described in this work.

2.4.1 PROFESSIONAL AUTOMOTIVE ENGINEERING TOOLS

In the automotive industry, several specialized software platforms exist for high-fidelity data acquisition, calibration, and analysis. These tools are primarily designed for original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) and their suppliers.

One widely used solution is CANoe, developed by Vector Informatik. The software is used for the development, analysis, and testing of electronic control units and distributed networks [7].

Another related tool from the same company is CANape, which focuses on measurement and calibration of ECU parameters during runtime. During measurement, engineers can adjust parameters while recording signals, with communication commonly handled via protocols such as XCP [8].

These tools provide extremely powerful capabilities but are typically expensive, require specialized hardware, and are primarily designed for ECU development rather than lightweight analysis of diagnostic telemetry data.

2.4.2 DIAGNOSTIC AND OBD-BASED TOOLS

Another category consists of tools designed for vehicle diagnostics using the OBD-II interface.

A well-known example is VCDS, developed by Ross-Tech. It is a diagnostic system for Volkswagen Group vehicles (VW, Audi, Škoda, and SEAT) [9].

Although such tools allow access to a wide range of vehicle parameters, their primary purpose is vehicle diagnostics rather than large-scale telemetry analysis. Data export and advanced analytical capabilities are typically limited compared to dedicated analysis platforms.

Some modern solutions attempt to extend OBD-based data analysis into broader telemetry applications. For example, platforms such as OBDAssistant provide real-time monitoring with hundreds of live parameters and AI-assisted interpretation of diagnostic information [10]. However, they are primarily targeted at consumer diagnostics and fleet monitoring rather than engineering analysis workflows.

2.4.3 TELEMETRY AND DATA ANALYSIS PLATFORMS

Several solutions exist that focus on telemetry visualization and analysis rather than diagnostics.

For instance, the AutoPi platform provides hardware and software solutions for collecting data from CAN, CAN-FD, and OBD-II networks and transmitting it to cloud infrastructure for fleet monitoring and analytics [11].

Similarly, specialized telemetry analysis portals are used in industrial contexts to store and evaluate machine data over long periods, allowing users to perform queries, generate reports, and define operational thresholds. These systems often integrate data from multiple hardware platforms and provide web-based dashboards for long-term analysis.

Another example is asammdf, an open-source tool and Python library designed for working with measurement data stored in the MDF format. It provides functionality for reading, writing, and processing MDF files and includes a graphical user interface for browsing signals, plotting telemetry data, and exporting measurements to other formats [12]. Because MDF is widely used in automotive testing environments, asammdf has become a popular tool for engineers and researchers working with recorded measurement datasets. In recent years, the tool has also started to see practical adoption within Škoda Auto, where it is gradually being used by engineers as an auxiliary tool for working with measurement data. However, it primarily focuses on processing MDF files rather than simplifying workflows built around CSV-based diagnostic data.

2.4.4 CONCLUSION ON EXISTING SOLUTIONS

Although the tools described above provide powerful capabilities, several limitations remain with respect to the workflow discussed in this work. Many professional engineering solutions require expensive licenses and specialized hardware. Dispite the fact large corporations may have access to such resources, including Škoda Auto, scope of the user base the results of this thesis is intended for is limited to a single department, and the cost of deploying such tools across the entire user base would be prohibitive.

In addition, most existing tools are designed primarily for ECU development, fleet monitoring, or vehicle diagnostics rather than for the post-processing and comparative analysis of telemetry data exported from OBD-II systems. As a result, working with multiple test runs often requires manual processing across several files, typically using external tools such as spreadsheet software.

Furthermore, many professional platforms rely on proprietary data formats or tightly integrated ecosystems, which complicates the use of simple CSV-based datasets commonly produced during diagnostic measurements. These limita-

tions motivate the development of a lightweight analysis tool specifically tailored to OBD-II telemetry data, with the goal of improving the efficiency and usability of the current workflow.

3 BUILDING THE APPLICATION

frameworks - tkinter vs pyqt (notable mentions for pygame)

3.1 VISUALIZATION

render framework selfbuilt renderer - layout strategy - backend - matplotlib backend

3.2 ANALYSIS

classic statistical methods machine learning methods supervised vs unsupervised - unsupervised needs to be monitored - we do monitor it so its the way to go

ODIS vs INCA (excel vs dat)

4 DEPLOYING TO PRODUCTION

4.1 TESTING

4.2 USER DOCUMENTATION

probably mkdocs on local server running under the desktop app

4.3 PACKAGING

pyinstaller, nuitka, brief comparison

5 POSSIBILITIES FOR IMPROVEMENT

rendering framework - figure management (we only do single figures rn)

6 CONCLUSION

conclusion type shit

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